

Quality Engineering Intern – Appian

Name : AJAY M S

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Role : Quality Engineering Intern

About the company:

Appian Corporation is a leading provider of a **low-code automation platform** that enables organizations to rapidly design, build, and deploy enterprise applications with minimal hand-coding. Appian integrates **process automation, case management, AI, robotic process automation (RPA), business rules, and data integration** into a unified environment. Its platform empowers businesses to streamline workflows, improve operational efficiency, and accelerate digital transformation. Appian serves industries such as **financial services, government, healthcare, and manufacturing**, providing both cloud-based and on-premises deployment options.

Online Assessment:

The Appian online assessment consisted of two primary sections:

1. **Multiple-Choice Questions (MCQs)** – These covered a range of topics, including:
 - **Aptitude:** Logical reasoning, numerical problem-solving, and puzzles.
 - **Basic SQL:** Basic use of keywords and retrieval of data from a database.
2. **Coding Challenge** – This section assessed problem-solving and programming skills. The specific task involved writing a program to determine whether a given list of strings contained any duplicate values. The solution was simple - iterating through the array and returning an appropriate result indicating the presence or absence of duplicates.

Interview:

The interview began on a cordial note with the classic *“Tell me about yourself”* opener, giving me a chance to set the stage. Without much delay, the interviewer presented me with a simple DSA challenge: **find the maximum element in an array**. While this might sound like a warm-up problem, it was relevant to the analytical nature of the **Quality Engineer** role — after all, even testers need to think like problem-solvers.

Next, we started discussing about my projects. One idea in particular caught the recruiter’s attention, and the conversation went from *“Tell me more”* to a full-on deep dive into the origin, functionality, and execution of the project. This set the tone for the next phase: testing knowledge. I explained the different types of testing I had implemented in my *“Hospital Appointment System”* Project, covering **Unit Testing, Integration Testing, and Regression Testing**.

Then came the main stuff — questions about **Artificial Intelligence** and whether it could design all test cases. I stood my ground, explaining that while AI is powerful, it lacks the hands-on experience of a seasoned quality engineer and might **hallucinate** (yes, I used the word) or overlook tricky edge cases. When asked why AI couldn’t test a project it had developed, I explained that AI is trained on existing data, while a human tester uses real-world insight to design precise, context-aware test cases. The interviewer countered that AI could do it, but I held my stance — politely but firmly.

We then shifted to **Selenium**, where I described how I used it to test a login page, walking the interviewer through the process from initiating a browser connection to gracefully shutting it down after testing.

Before wrapping up, I asked about **the secret behind Appian’s sustained success**, and the interviewer’s answer was as flawless as their product pitch.

Round Two (HR): This was a mix of introductions, “Why Appian?” and “Why this role?” — the standard HR essentials.

Round Three (Final HR): A quick check on whether I was comfortable with the role and a subtle nudge to see if I preferred a developer position instead. I

reaffirmed my interest in **Quality Engineering** and assured them I would align with the company's principles.

Tips:

For a Quality Engineer Intern role, a solid understanding of the **Software Testing Life Cycle (STLC)**, **Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC)**, and core testing concepts is essential. Focus on fundamental DSA topics such as **arrays, strings, hash maps, and sets**, as these are typically sufficient for the coding portion. Familiarity with testing tools like **Selenium** is a valuable advantage. Having a basic understanding of **CI/CD pipelines** can also strengthen your profile.

Be thoroughly prepared to discuss your projects in detail, as most technical questions will stem from your resume. Only list skills and topics in your resume that you are confident in, and ensure you can explain them clearly. Be clear in whatever you speak and BE CONFIDENT – your body language and attitude tells them a lot about you before you speak. Dress professionally, and ensure proper grooming to create a strong first impression.

ALL THE BEST!!

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